

Conclusively identified as **Lithobates catesbeianus**!

Classification result (scientific name, common name, confidence %)

1. Lithobates catesbeianus (American Bullfrog)	78.1%
2. Pelophylax ridibundus (Marsh Frog)	8.6%
3. Lithobates clamitans (Green Frog)	3.9%

► Show thinking (5 steps)

Lithobates catesbeianus (American bullfrog) is a species known for its distinctive appearance and ecological impact. Here are some key details:

Description

- **Appearance:** The dorsal surface is typically olive-green, sometimes with mottling or banding of grayish brown. The ventral surface is off-white, often blotched with yellow or gray. Notable features include a prominent eye with a brown iris and a horizontal pupil, and a visible tympanum (eardrum) behind the eye.
- **Size:** Adults range from 5 to 10 cm in body length and weigh between 28 to 85 grams.

Invasive Status in the UK

Lithobates catesbeianus is recognized as an **invasive species** in the UK. Its presence poses a threat to native frog populations due to its generalist diet and predatory behavior, which can lead to declines in indigenous species.

Recommendations

If you encounter Lithobates catesbeianus in the UK:

- **Do not release them:** If you have them as pets, do not release them into the wild.
- **Report sightings:** Notify local wildlife authorities or conservation organizations about any sightings to help monitor and manage their populations.
- **Avoid interaction:** Minimize contact with this species to prevent further spread and ecological disruption.

For more detailed information, you can refer to resources like the [Wikipedia page on the American bullfrog](#).

🚫 **This may be a regionally invasive species** — check local reporting/disposal rules before doing anything with it.

Sources:

- British Birds, Thorburn, Archibald, 1860-1935, 1915 (W. H. Hudson, 1895. Replaces unresolvable various-authors placeholder.) — <https://archive.org/details/britishbirds01thor>
- British Entomology (John Curtis), Curtis, John, 1791-1862, 1824 (Illustrated early UK insect reference.) — <https://archive.org/details/britishtentomolog01curt>
- The Birds of Great Britain, Sharpe, Richard Bowdler, 1847-1909, 1894 (John Gould, 5 volumes, 1862-1873.) — <https://archive.org/details/handbookgbbirds01sharich>
- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans

What is the scientific name of the American bullfrog and where is it native to?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The **scientific name** of the American bullfrog is **Lithobates catesbeianus**.

Native Range

This species is native to **eastern North America**, where it typically inhabits large permanent water bodies such as swamps, ponds, and lakes. It can also be found in manmade habitats like pools, canals, and reservoirs.

For more detailed information, you can refer to the [Wikipedia page on the American bullfrog](#).

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans

Why is it called a "bullfrog"?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The common name **"bullfrog"** for *Lithobates catesbeianus* is derived from the deep, bellowing call that male bullfrogs make during the breeding season, which resembles the sound of a bull. This distinctive vocalization is a key characteristic of the species and contributes to its common name.

The scientific name *catesbeianus* honors the English naturalist **Mark Catesby**, who was instrumental in documenting various species in North America.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans

What types of habitats does the American bullfrog typically inhabit?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The American bullfrog (*Lithobates catesbeianus*) typically inhabits a variety of large, permanent water bodies. These include:

- **Swamps**
- **Ponds**
- **Lakes**

Additionally, the bullfrog can be found in manmade habitats such as:

- **Pools**
- **Koi ponds**
- **Canals**
- **Ditches**
- **Reservoirs**
- **Culverts**

These diverse habitats provide the necessary conditions for breeding and foraging, making the bullfrog a highly adaptable species.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans

Is the American bullfrog considered an invasive species? If so, where?

► Show thinking (4 steps)

Yes, the American bullfrog (*Lithobates catesbeianus*) is considered an invasive species in several regions. It has been introduced in more than 40 countries and is particularly noted as invasive in:

- **British Columbia, Canada**
- **Western United States**
- **The Caribbean**
- **South America**
- **Western Europe** (including countries like Belgium, Italy, Spain, and Greece)
- **Parts of Asia** (including China, Japan, South Korea, and Malaysia)

The bullfrog's voracious appetite and high reproductive rate negatively impact native amphibians and other fauna in these areas.

🚫 **This may be a regionally invasive species** — check local reporting/disposal rules before doing anything with it.

Sources:

- British Birds, Thorburn, Archibald, 1860-1935, 1915 (W. H. Hudson, 1895. Replaces unresolvable various-authors placeholder.) — <https://archive.org/details/britishbirds01thor>
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- The Birds of Great Britain, Sharpe, Richard Bowdler, 1847-1909, 1894 (John Gould, 5 volumes, 1862-1873.) — <https://archive.org/details/handbookgbbirds01sharich>
- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans

Why are bullfrogs considered invasive and harmful to local ecosystems?

► Show thinking (4 steps)

The American bullfrog (*Lithobates catesbeianus*) is considered invasive and harmful to local ecosystems for several reasons:

1. **Predation on Native Species:** Bullfrogs are generalist carnivores, meaning they consume a wide variety of prey, including native amphibians. They directly prey on indigenous frog species, which can lead to significant declines in those populations.
2. **Disruption of Ecological Balance:** By consuming not only other frogs but also their predators (like dragonfly nymphs and garter snakes), bullfrogs disrupt the natural ecological checks that would normally control their populations. This can lead to an imbalance in the local ecosystem.
3. **High Reproductive Rate:** Bullfrogs produce a large number of eggs, which increases their chances of establishing self-sustaining populations in new environments. This reproductive strategy allows them to spread rapidly in areas where they are introduced.
4. **Resistance to Predation:** Bullfrogs exhibit traits that allow them to consume prey that would typically be avoided by other species due to their defenses. For example, they have been known to eat wasps and even scorpions without developing avoidance behaviors.
5. **Spread of Disease:** The American bullfrog has been associated with the spread of the amphibian pathogen *Batrachochytrium dendrobatidis*, which can have devastating effects on local amphibian populations.

These factors contribute to the American bullfrog's classification as an invasive species, particularly in regions where it has been introduced outside its native range.

⚠️ **This may be toxic or otherwise dangerous** — read the notes below before acting.

🚫 **This may be a regionally invasive species** — check local reporting/disposal rules before doing anything with it.

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- British Birds, Thorburn, Archibald, 1860-1935, 1915 (W. H. Hudson, 1895. Replaces unresolvable various-authors placeholder.) — <https://archive.org/details/britishbirds01thor>
- British Entomology (John Curtis), Curtis, John, 1791-1862, 1824 (Illustrated early UK insect reference.) — <https://archive.org/details/britishtentomolog01curt>
- The Birds of Great Britain, Sharpe, Richard Bowdler, 1847-1909, 1894 (John Gould, 5 volumes, 1862-1873.) — <https://archive.org/details/handbookgbbirds01sharich>
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- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans

What does the American bullfrog look like in terms of coloration?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The American bullfrog (*Lithobates catesbeianus*) has distinct coloration features:

- **Dorsal Surface:** The upper body typically displays an olive-green background, which may be plain or adorned with mottling and banding in grayish-brown.
- **Ventral Surface:** The underside is off-white, often blotched with yellow or gray.
- **Facial Features:** There is a noticeable contrast between the green upper lip and the pale lower lip. The eyes are prominent, featuring a brown iris and a horizontal, almond-shaped pupil.
- **Limbs:** The limbs are usually blotched or banded with gray, with the forelegs being short and sturdy, while the hind legs are long. The back toes have webbing, aiding in swimming.

These coloration patterns help the bullfrog blend into its aquatic environment, providing camouflage from predators.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog
- Wikipedia, "Lithobates clamitans" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lithobates_clamitans

For what purposes are bullfrogs used by humans?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The American bullfrog (*Lithobates catesbeianus*) is utilized by humans primarily for the following purposes:

1. **Culinary Use:** Bullfrogs are commonly consumed as food, especially in the southern United States. Their legs are particularly sought after and are often served as a delicacy.
2. **Fishing Bait:** In some regions, bullfrogs are used as bait for fishing due to their size and availability.
3. **Research and Education:** They are also used in scientific research and educational settings to study amphibian biology, ecology, and behavior.
4. **Pet Trade:** Although less common, bullfrogs can be found in the pet trade, where they are kept in aquariums or as exotic pets.

These uses have contributed to the species being introduced to various regions outside its native range.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog

Who is the species named after?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The species name *Lithobates catesbeianus* honors the English naturalist Mark Catesby.

Sources:

- Wikipedia, "American bullfrog" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_bullfrog

Ask a follow-up question...

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